



HUMANITAS  
INSTITUTE

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Bishop Louis Reicher Catholic School

School Website: <https://bishopreicher.com/>

January 7, 2026

**Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

**Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL****Classicality Audit: Bishop Louis Reicher Catholic School (Waco, TX)**

School website used: <https://bishopreicher.com/>

**Executive Summary**

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Bishop Louis Reicher Catholic School presents a robust Catholic identity with clear metaphysical grounding in virtue, theology, and liturgical life. The site evidences frequent use of positive classical keywords such as virtue, prudence, justice, fortitude, temperance, Eucharist, Mass, sacred liturgy, and theology, and it integrates a four-year theology sequence in high school. These strongly satisfy Religious and Metaphysical Foundations. The purpose statement frequently invokes forming students in what is true, good, and beautiful and emphasizes virtue formation; however, the site also markets college-prep priorities (PSAT, AP), and STEM/Robotics programming, which introduce mixed signals relative to classical aims. The curriculum includes “classical literature,” Latin, and Great Books authors (Homer, Sophocles, Shakespeare, Austen), but also foregrounds “Social Studies,” AP/college-readiness, and STEM initiatives. Pedagogy shows little explicit reference to classical methods (Socratic seminar, scholé, chanting/memorization), and includes experiential/hands-on/project language in Robotics. Faculty philosophy is not articulated in classical terms on the site. Parent partnership is explicit and hospitality is strong, though parent formation is not evident.

In sum: very strong Catholic formation + partial classical content + limited evidence of classical pedagogy and faculty formation □ SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

References for the classical lexicon and scoring framework were taken from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School keyword indicators and lexicon documents used in this audit.

---

**CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS****1) Keywords/phrases found on the school site**

- Positive indicators:
  - Virtue vocabulary and grounding in Aquinas: “faith, hope, and charity,” “prudence, justice, fortitude, temperance,” “Christ-centered life,” “Education in Virtue” (Dominican Sisters).
  - Theology integrated: “Each student undertakes a four-year theology program” with sacred scripture, moral and sacramental life, the Church.
  - Liturgical life: “daily prayer,” “weekly Mass,” “Eucharist,” and “regular participation in sacred liturgy and music”.
- Negative indicators: none found.

**2) Crosswalk to Six Elements lexicon**

- Positive matches include: virtue, wisdom, moral formation, theology, faith and reason, sacred scripture, liturgy, Mass, Eucharist, sacred music, reverence—all listed as positive indicators for Religious/Meta-physical.
- No negative signals (e.g., relativism, values□neutral) encountered from the lexicon.

## 3) Quantitative keyword tally

- Positives: 12
- Negatives: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Percent coverage of sub□elements (transcendentals/virtue; theology; liturgy): 100% (3/3)
- Pos/Neg hits: +12/-0

## 4) Rating

- CLASSICAL. Strong explicit alignment with virtue, theology, and liturgy.
- 

**CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL**

## 1) Keywords/phrases found

- Positive indicators:
  - “We foster what is good, true, and beautiful” (purpose language).
  - “Partner with families to form students into virtuous disciples of Christ” (formation).
- Negative indicators:
  - “PSAT,” “AP Calculus,” “college prep,” “National Merit recognition,” STEM□forward framing—signals of utilitarian/college□readiness emphasis when foregrounded as goals.

## 2) Cross□walk to Six Elements lexicon

- Positive matches: pursuit of the true, good, and beautiful; formation of wisdom and virtue.
- Negative matches: “college and career ready,” “workforce preparation,” “STEM” emphasis are listed as negatives when they dominate aims or displace formation.

## 3) Quantitative keyword tally

- Positives: 4
- Negatives: 4
- Percent positive: 50%
- Percent coverage of sub□elements (virtue/wisdom; true/good/beautiful; formation): 100% (3/3)
- Pos/Neg hits: +4/-4

## 4) Rating

- SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Strong formation language is offset by heavy college□prep/STEM marketing emphasis.
- 

**CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM**

## 1) Keywords/phrases found

- Positive indicators:
  - “Classical literature,” “Latin,” and Great Books authors (Homer, Sophocles, Shakespeare; also Austen, Dickens, Fitzgerald).

- Negative indicators:
  - “Social Studies” (terminology displacing “History”) on the elementary curriculum list.
  - STEM emphasis/AP framing and a prominent Robotics program highlighting “hands-on learning,” “coding,” engineering challenges, and competitions.
- 2) Crosswalk to Six Elements lexicon
- Positive matches: Great Books, primary sources/authors, Latin; trivium/quadrivium emphasis is not explicit on the site.
  - Negative matches: “Social Studies” replacing “History;” STEM-first framing; experiential/project-based language highlighted in programming (Robotics).
- 3) Quantitative keyword tally
- Positives: 5
  - Negatives: 4
  - Percent positive: 56%
  - Percent coverage of sub-elements (trivium/quadrivium; Great Books/history; wonder): ~50% (Great Books/authors and Latin noted; explicit trivium/quadrivium and wonder not evident)
  - Pos/Neg hits: +5/-4
- 4) Rating
- SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Classical authors and Latin are present; however, STEM/Robotics and Social Studies terminology temper the classical signal.
- 

## CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY OR TEACHING METHODS

- 1) Keywords/phrases found
- Positive indicators: No explicit references to Socratic dialogue, seminars, scholé/restful learning, chanting/memorization, or progymnasmata found.
  - Negative indicators:
  - Repeated “hands-on learning,” experiential/project-style language in Robotics; “problem-solving ... coding ... engineering challenges” and competitions.
- 2) Crosswalk to Six Elements lexicon
- Absence of positive pedagogy terms (Socratic, scholé, chanting/recitation) is notable; experiential/project-only framing is a negative signal when dominant.
- 3) Quantitative keyword tally
- Positives: 0
  - Negatives: 2
  - Percent positive: 0%
  - Percent coverage of sub-elements (Socratic; scholé; chanting; upper-school rhetoric): 0% (0/4)
  - Pos/Neg hits: +0/-2
- 4) Rating
- NOT CLASSICAL. Pedagogical evidence for classical methods is missing; experiential/hands-on project language is foregrounded.
- 

## CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

- 1) Keywords/phrases found

- Positive indicators: General phrases like “dedicated faculty” and “caring teachers,” but no explicit classical phrasing such as “teachers as models of virtue,” “living curriculum,” “faculty of friends,” or a “portrait of a teacher/student” found on public pages scanned.
  - Negative indicators: none explicit.
- 2) Crosswalk to Six Elements lexicon
- Positive faculty markers (mentorship/collegiality, virtuous exemplars) are not articulated in classical terms on the site.
- 3) Quantitative keyword tally
- Positives: 0
  - Negatives: 0
  - Percent positive: 0%
  - Percent coverage of subelements (model teachers; living curriculum; collegial culture; portrait): 0%
  - Pos/Neg hits: +0/-0
- 4) Rating
- NOT CLASSICAL. Insufficient evidence of classical faculty vision/formation.
- 

## CATEGORY 6: PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

- 1) Keywords/phrases found
- Positive indicators:
  - “We partner with families to form students ...” (explicit parent partnership).
  - Open campus hospitality: personal tours, coffee & tour events, shadow days, and open houses.
  - Negative indicators: No direct “parents as customers only” language. No explicit parent formation/book clubs found.
- 2) Crosswalk to Six Elements lexicon
- Positive matches: partnership with parents; open campus/hospitality. Parent formation opportunities are not in evidence.
- 3) Quantitative keyword tally
- Positives: 3
  - Negatives: 0
  - Percent positive: 100%
  - Percent coverage of subelements (partnership; parent formation; open hospitality): ~67% (2/3)
  - Pos/Neg hits: +3/-0
- 4) Rating
- SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Clear partnership and hospitality; add parent formation to strengthen.
- 

## Aggregate Assessment

- Religious & Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL (+12/-0; 100% coverage, 100% positive)
- Purpose & Goal: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (+4/-4; 100% coverage, 50% positive)
- Curriculum: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (+5/-4; ~50% coverage, 56% positive)
- Pedagogy: NOT CLASSICAL (+0/-2; 0% coverage, 0% positive)
- Faculty: NOT CLASSICAL (+0/-0; 0% coverage, 0% positive)
- Parents & Community: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (+3/-0; ~67% coverage, 100% positive)

Overall rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Rationale: Strong Catholic metaphysics and some classical content (Latin, classical literature/Great Books authors) are offset by limited evidence of classical pedagogy and faculty formation, and by mixed signals in curriculum framing (AP/PSAT/STEM/Robotics leading) relative to a classically ordered program. Evidence is grounded in the school's pages (virtue program, theology/-Mass/Eucharist, academics/Robotics, and visit/open house pages) and scored against the classical lexicon and keyword indicators, with criteria drawn from the Six Elements framework and lexicon.

---

### What would move the needle

- Pedagogy: Publish explicit commitments to classical methods (Socratic seminar in upper school humanities; chanting/recitation/memory work in lower school; restful learning/scholé language; progymnasmata/rhetoric orations). Concrete program statements would transform Pedagogy from NOT CLASSICAL to SOMEWHAT/CLASSICAL per the lexicon.
  - Curriculum framing: Keep Latin/classical literature prominent and add explicit trivium/quadrivium language, Great Books lists by grade, and "History" (not "Social Studies"). De-emphasize college-prep/STEM as primary aims and frame them as means under the telos of wisdom/virtue and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty.
  - Faculty formation: Add a "Portrait of a Classical Teacher," emphasize teachers as models of virtue, and describe ongoing faculty formation in classical pedagogy (e.g., faculty colloquia on Great Books).
  - Parent formation: Offer parent book studies or seminars introducing classical education and the liberal arts tradition; articulate parents as co-educators in the classical project.
- 

### Evidence Highlights (from the school site)

- Virtue & theology: Dominican "Education in Virtue" (Aquinas; theological and cardinal virtues) and four-year theology sequence; daily prayer/weekly Mass/Eucharist; sacred liturgy/music.
  - Purpose: "foster what is good, true, and beautiful," "form students" (formation language).
  - Curriculum: "classical literature," Latin; authors such as Homer/Sophocles/Shakespeare/Austen; but AP/PSAT/STEM also highlighted; "Social Studies" appears in elementary list.
  - Pedagogy: Robotics page emphasizes "hands-on learning," "projects," "coding," competitions; no Socratic/scholé/chanting references found.
  - Parents & community: Partnership language and multiple hospitality/on-campus visit options (tours, coffees, shadow days, open houses).
-

## Appendix

### ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.